
Violence and Resistance in Elizabeth Liard's A Little Piece of Ground (2003)

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Abstract

This analysis utilizes Martin Luther King Jr.'s concepts of violent and non-violent resistance alongside Barbara Harlow's theory of resistance literature, concentrating on the internal conflicts and generational tensions on optimal methods of opposing oppression. As Malak's resistance manifests subtly via acts of compassion and perseverance, Karim contemplates his inclination towards more overt disobedience. Both stories underscore the notion of sumud (steadfastness), depicting resilience as a formidable expression of defiance. The research elucidates how Palestinian children sustain agency amidst profound oppression by examining quotidian acts of resistance, such as playing football and nurturing hope. The study asserts that these works substantially enhance Palestinian resistance literature by offering both young readers and adults a deep comprehension of the emotional and political intricacies encountered by children in conflict zones.

KeyWords

Palestinian, children, resistance, sumud, political

Introduction

Elizabeth Laird is a British writer born in 1943 in New Zealand. Laird grew up in Malaysia, Lebanon and Ethiopia, where her father worked as a diplomatic officer. Laird was greatly influenced by the diverse experiences she had during her childhood in these different countries. Liard's multicultural upbringing and

diverse life experiences have greatly influenced her writing on Palestine. Laird is one of the writers seeking to demonstrate the question of Palestine and the impact of Israel's occupation on the daily lives of Palestinians. She uses its narratives to highlight issues such as justice, freedom and belonging, and accurately describes the challenges faced by Palestinians under occupation.

Using a sober and realistic approach, Laird highlights the tragedy Palestinians are experiencing and exposes the impact of the occupation on their daily lives. Her stories are used to communicate individuals' experiences and difficulties, helping to promote awareness of the Palestinian cause. Overall, Elizabeth Laird's multicultural upbringing and experiences around the world have poignantly influenced her writing about Palestine, as she seeks to highlight the issue of Palestinians and the impact of the occupation on their lives.

News of scattered Palestinian violent resistance used to be at the background of the daily life of Karim's family: "Palestinian gunman had shot two people in an Israeli café two weeks ago" (Laird 11). On TV there are daily news of Palestinians' shootings, and bombings: "five Israeli women died, and three children were badly injured when a Palestinian gunman opened fire in a crowded shopping street in Jerusalem this morning" (Laird 15). In *A Little Piece of Ground*, there are very few Palestinians who support violence as a method of resistance, which they justify as one of the only methods available against Israel's powerful army that has killed many Palestinian civilians. They believe that Palestinians, like other oppressed people, have the "right to resist" the Israeli occupation with armed force.

Throughout the novel, Laird clarifies how easily Palestinian young men would endorse violent resistance. It shows the development of many young Palestinians who "had been mere children, watching the struggle from the sidelines, keeping out of trouble as their parents had always urged them to do" (91). Once, they grow up and witness the injustice of the occupation, they become more extreme in viewing the way they must resist the occupation. As Joni puts it, after he listens to Hopper's story of how

his family is forced to live in a refugee camp: “you can’t exactly blame them, when you go around pretending to blow things up” (121). As a matter of fact, through the character of Karim, Laird indicates that there are two main incidents that makes him praise the violent resisters: the humiliation of his father at the Israeli checkpoints and the Israeli settlers’ stealing of his family’s farm. (Deyab 7)

Types of Resistance:

- The means and methods of resistance varied in Elizabeth Liard's *A Little Piece of Ground*, and the researcher describes in this chapter these types of resistance, such as what Martin Luther King, Jr. (1957) described, as he focused on ways to confront oppression. He explained three ways the oppressed perform in the face of the oppressors throughout history; delusion: physical violence, bow and nonviolent resistance.

Perhaps delusion is considered one of the most dangerous types of resistance due to what the oppressed resort to physical violence, in addition to the reason for its uselessness, as violence does not solve any social problems, it creates new, more complex things. King believes that violent resistance is one of the very wrong things, and on the contrary, it drags them even more, as he put it (Hollander et al. 536).

As King remarks:

In the struggle for human dignity, the oppressed peoples of the world must not allow themselves to become embittered or indulge in campaigns of hate. Revenge with hatred and bitterness will do nothing but intensify the hatred in the world. Along the way of life, he must have A person who is sufficiently sensitive and moral enough to cut the chain of hate. This can only be done by highlighting the ethics of love at the heart of our lives

According to King, violent resistance is one of the things that usually generates hatred and revenge, and this matter is not only within the targeted oppressor, but among external viewers who have little awareness of the connection between the oppressed relationship, and according to what Immanuel Kant 1983 said, violent resistance, as he said, "is capable of generating Intense feelings of hatred and revenge that threaten to undermine trust and the possibility of future coexistence" (33)

Physical violence is associated with submission to the resistance in terms of how the oppressed tacitly adapted to oppression, and likewise it became conditioned by it, which indicates that the oppressed are accustomed to oppression accepting oppression as part of their actions in life, Or King's use of the Prophet Moses, peace be upon him, as an example, where he led the Children of Israel from the slavery of Pharaoh in Egypt to the freedom of the Promised Land, he quickly discovered that the slaves would not welcome this permanently, as they were accustomed to this situation and adapted to the situation of slavery, and this type of resistance does not encourage him as King said:

“Passive acceptance of an unjust system represents co-operation with this system, so that the oppressed becomes as evil as the oppressor.... The oppressed must never be allowed by the conscience of the oppressor to sleep.... He can never win the respect of his oppressor by acquiescence, so that the oppressor increases his arrogance and contempt.”

The third type of resistance is what the oppressed can adopt in their struggle to obtain freedom and nonviolent resistance that "nines to reconcile two contradictory realities," and the most prominent of them is submission and violence linked to avoiding extremism and debauchery for both, and here King notes:

“The method of effective non-violent resistance, as they enjoy the same method of resistance, which is disarming the opponent, exposing his moral defenses and weakening his morale, and at the same time working on his conscience, and this matter is the beauty of non-violence. Struggle without hate is linked to waging war without violence.”

King recommended here that resistance without violence comes according to the following reasons: first: non-violence is one of the most effective things because it aims to understand the opponent and gain his friendship and not to humiliate him. Second: resisting persecution is important, as the people who commit this act will not be suppressed unless they resist persecution itself. Third: nonviolent resistance requires avoiding physical and external violence and internal violence of the spirit, so that non-violent resistance not only refuses to shoot the opponent, but also rejects hatred. Fourth: believers in nonviolent resistance have a deep belief in the future, and it stems from the conviction that the universe is integrated with justice.

Through the aforementioned reasons, the researcher sheds light on three methods that as identified clearly in *A Little Piece of Ground* by Elizabeth Laird, where the main characters differ in applying them and he transform the approach that they had to follow in confronting the Israeli occupation, for some characters, especially adults, they prefer endurance as a means of resistance, where's others, especially young persons, join non-violent resistance and get involved in it.

A Little Piece of Ground:

Elizabeth Laird clarifies a series of events in her novel and relies on the narration of real events from the incidents that come from the main Israeli site for human rights, and others were taken from experiences that were narrated in a lecture at Bir Zeit University in the West Bank, such as: The novel reflected the types of resistance by shedding light on her family and the surroundings around it, as it clarified the types of violence that the family was

subjected to, and the Palestinian children grew up on. When indirect persecution represented by economic difficulties, threatening the family structure and forcing people to emigrate.

It showed A Little Piece Of Ground and how the daily life of the Palestinians is full of cruel practices of power, as stated in some of the writer's terminology, as Liard indicated in the words of the protagonists, the most important of whom is "Karim", when he said, "Whatever you try to do in this country, wherever you want to go, the enemy is Always there to stop you. Even a simple game of football was impossible," (85), Don Milligan said, "Palestinians are oppressed - denied the exercise of equal rights - by the Jewish state of Israel, and by many of its agencies," and especially that they are denied the rights to life itself as they suffer from bombing Israeli forces on refugee camps in Gaza, resulting in many Palestinian victims and deaths, even young children do not escape bullets "Israeli forces bombed a refugee camp in Gaza this morning, killing nine Palestinians, including a three-year-old child." (Al Mezan center for human rights).

The entire city and homes could be destroyed without clear reasons. "There were reports that Israeli tank shells damaged parts of the city center and demolished entire buildings," (Al Mezan center for human rights). In addition to the collective punishments that Israel uses. These measures are carried out against groups of Palestinians, such as "military closures, curfews, random searches, checkpoints, house demolitions, uprooting of vineyards and olive groves, and construction of thousands of housing units (settlements) on confiscated land". (Al Mezan center for human rights).

Laird's account referred to many of the things that happen and the conditions resulting from the Israeli occupation in the entire city of Ramallah under the brunt of the curfew for a period of twenty-four hours, and the curfew reached for weeks as a kind of collective punishment for the Palestinians. Because of this repeated ban, the Palestinians were trapped inside their homes, and were unable to get out, as when one of the people tried to get out, the soldiers shot him. Moreover, they were shooting at anyone if he

tried to put his foot outside, in addition to firing explosives at them, which explains the suffering of many patients, as they may lose their lives under the curfew, and one of the most prominent examples Karim's mother "complains that if they had kept us here for another day, the child's [Karim's sister] ear infection would have spread to her brain. In any case, we almost ran because we ran out of food." (16)

Perhaps the most devastating effect of the curfew lies in its impact on the Palestinian economy, as *A Little Piece Of Ground* depicts how the economic situation of the Palestinians it is really bad because of the curfew. An example of that is the poetry of Karim's father, "Hassan Aboudi" because he is supposed to support his family and provide for their needs, but he feels helpless because of the curfew, so that he cannot open his shop and continue his work, especially since in this difficult period, no one is interested in buying electronics at the time of the curfew, and there is also no electricity in the city, and this situation is more difficult for men. Karim's father is incapacitated and humiliated by his inability to earn money and feed and clothe his family, so he does not calm down and does not feel bored and humiliated as he says to himself, "I am the type who lives on his wife now, right? And we are the type that deals with the salary of one secretary part-time. Isn't that just wonderful?" (34).

In the world of Karim, humiliation is a constant part of their daily lives, as there are no laws that protect him in a positive and effective way. He and other Palestinians, and he lives in a lawless area, and perhaps it is an exceptional case from other residents who have rights and protection. For example Karim's family owns a piece of land in their village, but, it was confiscated and given to Israeli settlers. In addition, his father could not support the family financially because of the curfew. He was also shot by a soldier and escaped with answers after bleeding for hours.

The curfew is not considered the only type of collective repression method, as many Palestinians suffer from this method. The novel showed that it occurs on a daily basis, and the Palestinians were subjected to humiliation, arrest, and detention

after the curfew was lifted, and this is exactly what happened to Shaqq Hooper "Salim" at one of the Israeli checkpoints when he refused to yield to the female soldier's frustrated demands. "This soldier, a woman, told Salem to show his ID, and he gave her his card, and she picked it up and threw it in the mud, then asked him to pick it up, pick it up, or you'll see what you get." (114).

As a result of the humiliating treatment the Palestinians were subjected to, "Salim lost his temper." (115). He grabbed the Israeli's arm and started shaking it and screaming. For his reaction, Salem had to remain in an Israeli prison for several years, without even having a chance at a fair trial, "Without charges being brought, a Palestinian can be imprisoned and held for months or years in administrative detention. The same law does not apply to Israeli Jews"(Kevorkian et al. 401).

In addition, many Palestinians in Israeli prisons are subjected to a difficult stage of humiliation and torture. When Hooper's brother "Salem" was arrested, they abused him in many ways, they beat him and put him in a dirty bag, placing the bag on his head so that he could not see, and he had to breathe this filth for a long time. He was sitting on a small chair with his arms folded, his hands tied behind his ankles, and he was left for a long time to feel the pain all the time.

The writer explains what most Palestinians suffer when laws and regulations were put in place to exclude certain population groups from the rights granted to them, and to impose curfews on them, meaning that the result is not far from dictatorship activating all legal decisions, and above all distinguishing between the worker and the private. The Palestinian territories became lawless spaces, a vivid example of how exceptional cases such as aggressive action work, and in the case of a suicide attack. For Karim, the collective punishment of him was one aspect of the occupation that was troubling, as this collective treatment places the Palestinian population in an exceptional situation and is effectively excluded from the rights and protections that law affords to others.

Types of Resistance in *A Little Piece of Ground*

Lori Allen explains in his sonorous words, "Temples of injustice do not just vanish; they must be confronted, witnessed, attacked, and if necessary, burned to the ground." All Palestinian personalities feed on the Israeli occupation and believe that "it cannot go on forever, and it cannot be this bad forever." They all agreed that resistance is a legitimate right of the Palestinian people because it is the right of any people living under oppression, colonialism and foreign occupation.

Although they disagree about the appropriate methods of resistance that he should take, in fact the three paths of resistance outlined by King are evident, especially in *A Little Piece of Ground*, as the novel embodies the violent resistance of young Palestinians carrying guns and bombing Israeli places.

It also shows how some Palestinians see that resistance is not limited to carrying weapons, it could be drawing a Palestinian flag and throwing stones. Finally, it depicts the third type of Palestinians who believe that they will not achieve anything through violent resistance and believe that they simply exist and stand firmly on their land. The Palestinians are resisting reality. For them, resistance is basically a moral struggle, as Linda Helgesen says.

"Palestinian resistance ideology reflects a view of resistance as essentially moral. It is through moral superiority that the battle against Israel shall be won, by the exhibiting of greater virtues of courage, stamina, and will sacrifice by the Palestinian people. In opposition to this, the concept of 'collaborator' and 'corruption' and what these concepts signify is deeply connected with immorality".

To classify the resistance activities on which the Palestinian youth are based, Philip Leach considers this resistance to be of three types: nonviolence - associated with the narrative of resilience, victimization and appeal to "justice" and armed resistance and terror - associated with the "heroic" novel.

The writer embodied the idea of *A Little Piece of Ground* that resists these fears by calling for an end to the occupation and revealing some of the consequences of this occupation on Palestinian children, such as "Karim". For Palestinian children who are on the land, they simply become resistance, as it was clear that Karim realizes that resistance is sometimes simply in its location. It refuses to concede and after he thought about the matter well, he found that whoever resists also resists in the way that suits him. His mere presence in this land and holding on to his own under their noses was an act of resistance. As soon as he clung on and did not allow them to expel him from the land of Hooper because he was defending Palestine.

An implicit or more implicit form of resistance in the perception of Palestinian society as diverse and heterogeneous, in the Commonwealth Michael Hardt-Negry has shown that the revolution requires the empowerment of different versions of identity, which they call exclusivity as an alternative to the collective effort that erases individual identities. The resistance is considered the most important one of the challenges of the revolution today, which is indicated by the parallel between the singularities, which is that the revolutionary action cannot be managed successfully or contemplated in one field only, without parallel developments, as the revolutionary struggle tends to the storm of things and backfires on itself.

Parallelism is suggested here for the oppressed to gain their freedom, and they must resist not just as an entity but as parallel individuals who share the common goal of erasing oppression, in "*A Little Piece of Ground*", and it represents an important narrative strategy from the diversity of the Palestinian people, and among the examples mentioned by the writer here are the closest friends Karim, who is "Johnny," a Christian boy from the middle class, and Hooper, a poor Muslim refugee boy. The Palestinians can challenge the prominent discourse of domination that portrays them as a homogeneous people. When the discourse of domination fails to do so, it becomes difficult to simply marginalize the issue towards the Palestinian struggle.

Violent Resistance:

The violent resistance appears in the novel through the scattered and violent news of the Palestinian resistance against the background of the daily life of the Karim family, "A Palestinian gunman shot two people in an Israeli cafe two weeks ago" (15) the daily news broadcast on television about shootings and bombings against Palestinians, such as "Five Israeli women were killed, and three children injured" (15) eloquent when a Palestinian gunman opened fire on a crowded shopping street in Jerusalem this morning. In *A Little Piece of Ground* very few Palestinians support violence as a method of resistance and justify it as one of the only methods available against a powerful Israeli army that kills menacing Palestinian addicts. They believe that the Palestinians, like other oppressed people, have the "right to resist" the Israeli occupation by armed force. Throughout the novel, Laird demonstrates how easily violent resistance can be endorsed by Palestinian youth.

The novel shows the development of many young Palestinians who were just children. The children in Palestine are forced to watch the struggle from the sidelines and stay out of trouble as their parents constantly urged them to do. Palestinian children do not have the luxury of playing and choosing like other children because they live in a different environment and an unsafe homeland in which acts of violence, killing and bombing are common scenes they see in their daily lives. They must resist substitution, says Johnny after listening to Hopper's story about how his family was forced into family and living in a refugee camp. "You can't exactly blame them, when you go around pretending to blow things up." (121).

On their way to visit their grandmother's village, the Israeli soldiers stopped Karim's family at a military checkpoint, as Karim's father had to get out of the car and take off his clothes in a professional manner. Karim witnesses how the occupation makes his father less humane by treating him in an inhuman way. His

father's image as the family's lawyer is shattered as the family is gone forever.

"There was a burning pain inside of him. He had never thought much of his father before... He always assumed that his father knew well that his decisions were right, that he could protect his family and would always be there to give advice, that he would know what was right and what was wrong. All Those sure things changed in his mind when he saw his father's humiliation. Hot and red anger pulsated behind his eyes" (46).

This dominating scene is a turning point in Karim's character. "His desire to laugh is gone. He couldn't believe he felt it at all. He thought that's what they wanted. To make us look ridiculous" (46). As a result, Karim was filled with anger and hatred towards the Israelis. "I hate them. I hate them. I hated them, he thought, unable now to look at his father, who still stood, reduced to a dark sneer, beside the distraught old man"(48).

The other event that prompted Karim to declare takfir is the violent resistance, as a results of the brutal actions of the Israeli settlers towards the Palestinians, and Karim knows that the Israeli settlers attacked a village last night. Three Palestinians were killed, and one settler was wounded, and the soldiers closed the road and did not allow anyone to pass. Therefore, he exposed himself to the deliberate intimidation of his family at the hands of the settlers. When Karim went with his uncle Abu Faisal to fetch olives from the family farm, the Israeli settlers attacked them and said to them: "Your olives? forget that. And this part of the settlement now has

olive harvest here again, and you want to shoot? No? So, get out now” (54).

Karim felt his uncle's powerlessness in the face of the settlers, as he witnessed how Abu Faisal "appeared from behind the tree in which he hid. 'This place,' he exclaimed bravely, 'is ours.' We have the papers [...] The only answer was a bullet that hit the tree on eight inches from his hand” (55). Following this immediate incident, Karim has been miserable all afternoon, ever since they returned from the olive groves, and he thinks of his weakness in the face of the settlers' oppression, “weak, weak” (59).

He thought, remembering with trembling how half-naked Hassan Aboudi stood under the despicable stare of the soldiers, and how he was running like a cabbage afraid of the settlers' guns. These two incidents affected Karim directly and truly. As neighbors of his family's land, Karim reconsiders the whole situation, which forces him to consider violent resistance as the only option. "They take our land and kill us. We must fight and kill them. This is justice! That's all!" (63) to the sound of gunshots far from the city and he liked this type of resistance because it meant that some Palestinians were resisting the Israelis "The Palestinians must be shooting; he decided..... A wild joy came, for all his misery. There was someone to resist invaders” (Al Mezan center for human rights).

Acquiescence:

According to King, submission means absolute submission to oppression so that the oppressed get used to oppression. Moreover, submission, although the easiest way is often not the moral way, is the way of the coward, and it is "*A little piece of Ground*." There are some Palestinians who were described by Martin King is "so weary of the yoke of injustice that they abandon it." Although they suffer greatly from Israeli oppression, they have no choice but to submit, and only accept their position and adjust their way of life to accommodate them. In addition, the Palestinians silently accept their oppressive conditions so that they create what Paulo Freire calls a culture of silence (Martin Luther King Jr).

Individuals who have been persecuted become so helpless that they do not even talk about their persecution, especially if they reach the stage of persecution which creates a culture in which it is forbidden to even mention the injustices that are committed, and the oppressed are silenced, as they have no voice and no will. Laird described the number of Palestinians who have become miserable in all kinds of change and accept their destruction without any resistance and prefer to "flight" instead of "stay" and resist the occupation. One of the best examples of this is acquiescence in "*A Little Piece of Ground*", which is the desire of some Palestinians to immigrate to another country.

Migration as a form of resistance

One of the best examples of King's acquiescence to the issue of "*A little piece of Ground*" is the decision of many Palestinians to emigrate, and as one of Karim's cousins said, "I'm not an idiot, it's emigration for me" (58). Laird points out that there are some Palestinians, even young people among them, who think of emigration as the only hope for them, and claim that they are finished, or in a more precise sense, "Palestine is over" (59). They want to go to America just because "the children will have a better future." As one of Karim's cousins stated of his desire to emigrate, "I've been thinking about it for a long time... My brother owns a pharmacy in Boston. I could stay with him until I got started there" (59). When Karim listened to this conversation, he became angry and could no longer bear the conversation.

Like many Palestinians, the main reason for Johnny's father's leaving Palestine is the difficulties the children suffer from, had it not been for his children.

"George and Rose have been talking about things for months when they decide they have to go to him only, for the good of the families and they are really lucky that they have the opportunity..... A partnership awaits him in this field which is a good school for Johnny" (199).

Boutros asserts that he will not leave his country, "It's only temporary. Only until things get better here." However, Karim knows, "This is what the refugees say"(199). Karim always believes that the Palestinian problem will not be solved by fleeing, because emigration is not a solution to Israeli oppression. Unlike Johnny's father, who faced a decision to stay or leave, Karim chose, considering Hopper's status as a refugee, to stick to his status so as not to become a refugee like Hopper. "I am happy that I am." I'm not a refugee, Karim thought. He had never wondered before about what the situation should be like for the people of the camp" (200). By knowing the history of Hooper's life in the refugee camp, Karim realizes that Israel has been encouraging the Palestinians to leave their homes and lands since 1948 AD, and based on what Karim felt of refusing to surrender and the Israeli pressure to leave their home is the best way for him.

"They did not crush me; I will not allow them. They will never crush me" (208). By remaining in Palestine, it is a comparative matter: "We will remain here, no matter what they do to us" (212). Here, Karim expresses the true meaning of the word healthy resistance when he declared his strong determination to remain in Palestine, regardless of what the Israelis did to him and his family. His choice to remain in his country is the best example of nonviolent resistance.

Nonviolent Resistance:

In spite of the violent resistance that Karim praised "we must be like bombers and kill as many as possible he, himself never

participated in any violent actions aimed at killing Israelis, on the contrary he seeks non-violent resistance, which is something between violent resistance and acquiescence" (65). An example of this is that Karim never mentions in his wish list any desire to kill any Israeli, and he has a very simple dream: "I don't live under occupation. Israeli soldiers didn't stop him all the time. Not being afraid. They don't get trapped inside" (8).

His desire for the list to be "the inventor of an acidic formula for dissolving hardened steel as used in (Israeli) tanks and helicopters" (7), expressing a generous sense of nonviolent resistance instead of using weapons and killing people, and simply wants to disarm the Israeli occupation one of the killing machines he uses against defenseless Palestinians, however, as he witnesses the oppression that the people around him suffer, Karim asks why the Palestinians did not stand up to the oppression earlier, "How could they do that?" here, he exploded with anger, "He forbade us from picking olives! Our land! They just stole it! Why didn't anyone stop them" (56). Karim is totally against accepting his people as he gets angry when he watches the people around him accept the

Nobody does anything, my father stripped him naked!

Then they shot him - we - in our olive groves but he does

nothing. Back there, when they all heard about the suicide

bomber - the martyr - all they could talk about was whether

they would come back Right home or not. I'm so ashamed!"

(62).

occupation.

Karim thinks of the need for active resistance against the occupation, "You could have done something! Anything" (56). King agrees that submission, although it is often the easiest way, is

not the moral way. It is the way of the coward and believes that he must do something for his father and his country, and here he believes strongly that one's will can do impossible things. " The defeatism of others annoyed him. Looking at the rock, his eyes narrowed. People have moved on with big things. The ancient Egyptians did it. Brute force was not enough. You had to be smart - to work things out"(87).

One could argue that Karim's advocacy of nonviolent resistance was influenced by his uncle Abu Faisal's nonviolent ideas. For example, Karim begins by reflecting on what his uncle said about the Israelis that "they were bad, good, moral, immoral, some greedy and vain, some good-hearted and suffering, all men" (63). And women and children - like the rest of us. Humans" (63). While hiding among the ruins of a shattered left, Karim had the opportunity to watch Israeli soldiers on the books. At first, Karim blamed the cat "Aziza". As it approached the Israeli soldiers, "Traitor! Don't approach them.... Karim thought of her disgust that she was taking food from Aziza." (177) To Karim's surprise, the soldier was playing with Aziza and hitting her neck. "He was playing with her, talking. Quietly, as if he already knows her, and as if he understands what she loves" (178) so he began to see the humanity of the soldiers in dealing with the cat and that the Israeli soldier is just a human who receives orders from his superiors.

Perhaps the other incident that Karim or these Israeli soldiers do not view as enemies but as human brothers and sisters is when Karim looked at the soldier and noticed that "for a moment, for a split second, the hated soldier began to dress up as the invaders, just like Jamal, which means that Karim's problem is not With the soldier, but with the oppressive regime that the soldier serves. In other words, Karim believes that the Palestinian resistance should be directed towards the unjust policies and practices of the Israeli government, and not the extermination of the Israeli people like King. It was Karim's belief that the resistance should be against the forces of evil and not against the people trapped in these forces, and that we seek to defeat it and not the people who are victims of evil ("Nonviolence and Racial Justice").

The remarkable process of nonviolent resistance pursued by Karim with other Palestinian youth is summarized in the following: first, throwing stones at the occupation soldiers. Second, drawing the Palestinian flag on the soccer field. According to Princess Hass (2013)

We can say that the idea of throwing stones is one of the acquired and obligatory rights of any person subject to foreign rules, and throwing stones is a metaphor for resistance. Teitelbaum and Kostiner considered that stone throwing has a symbolic meaning. In addition, the Palestinians see stones to express their defiance and anger.

Moreover, throwing stones is considered a challenge rather than an intention to injure in the literal sense of enthusiasm or violence, saying that stones (in most cases), and it is not possible to cause harm to well-equipped helmeted soldiers, and young men resort to throwing stones as a form of expression of protest against the presence of the Israeli army on their land and for young Palestinians who suffer from a deep sense of humiliation and despair. This simple and tangible act of resistance is often a means of psychological survival by restoring a sense of empowerment in a miserable and depressing environment.

In addition to the previous reasons, Laird adds many reasons, such as the hatred and anger that prompted the youths to throw stones at the Israeli soldiers, as she remarks:

"Karim felt the usual punch of fear and hatred at the sight of the enemy. He could see from the tension that the four young men in front of him were suffering from that they felt it as well. They were collecting stones now because they only needed to bend over in order to collect any number of small rocks, broken pieces of concrete and broken pieces of pavement, almost all of which were destroyed by the tanks"(145).

In fact, Karim and other young men throw stones to send a **"Stone throwing is often a result of boredom, excessive hormones, imitation, ostentation and competition. But in the composition the internal aspect of the relationship between the occupier and the occupied, throwing stones is the adjective associated with the (Amira Hassan)" theme We are tired of you occupiers.**

message to the occupiers that they are tired of the occupation and to inform their oppressors that they have reached their fullest limits, as Amira Has said,

This horrendous experience between equipped Israeli troopers and stone throwing Palestinian youth addressed quite possibly of the haziest crossroads in Israel's set of experiences and was maybe the least, most degenerate crossroads throughout the entire existence of the Israeli armed force.

In A Little Piece of Ground, Stone tossing is a message from the young men in Palestine towards the occupiers that they are tossing stones not to kill or hit someone but rather to let their oppressors know that they are unwanted guests in their territory. Moreover, part of Jamal's and his companions' procedure against the occupation is to show it as ludicrous. At the point when television news shows youthful Palestinians toss stones at the gigantic Israeli tanks, the world observers the disparity between unarmed Palestinians and the Israeli armed force.

At the point when for the most part unarmed Palestinian regular citizens went up against intensely equipped Israeli fighters during the beginning phases of the primary Intifada, this uncovered the enormous power inconsistency among occupiers and involved, and made the tactical occupation look absurd. The ridiculous showdown between one of the most grounded armed forces on the planet with a gathering of young men tossing stones force large number of harmony activists from around the world to join the Palestinian peaceful opposition and spur even many Israeli's tranquility activists to legitimize the youthful Palestinians' utilization of stones. Many "Israeli harmony activists thought the occupation debased them, made them not exactly human, as well as abusing Palestinians ". Likewise, this significantly affects the ethics of the Israeli armed force itself. As per Yaron Ezrahi notes:

The other peaceful movement that Karim and his companions are participating is attracting a Palestinian banner their little piece of ground. The only one dream that Karim, Container

and Joni have is to wrap up painting a banner on their little piece of ground: They organized the green stones in a long strip and put a white stripe close to it. Two dark receptacle liners, discharged out, gave sufficient plastic to cover the stones expected to make the third stripe. The red stone, creatively organized, framed the triangle toward one side of the banner.

Having a banner in that land represents their fantasy to progress forward with regardless of the cruel conditions of the occupation: "we could do a banner ... assuming that we utilize free stone. We could paint some and enclose the others by dark or white plastic sacks. We could just spread them out on the ground"(57). Their emphasis on drawing a Palestinian banner insists their dynamic obstruction against the Israeli persecution and treachery. The banner is utilized to communicate their profound pride of their country; it is an image of faithfulness and having a place. After they have completed the banner, they felt an enlarging pride, another certainty. They'd accomplished something here, on this little piece of ground. They'd made it genuinely theirs.

The banner addresses an image of trust and strength and that there is yet a continuous battle for opportunity that they get helped to remember at whatever point they see the banner. It is really a message to the Israeli warriors that they are yet alive, and they are digging in for the long haul for eternity. Even though he has been caught in his little piece of ground, to Karim, the banner addresses his fantasy of a free Palestine. It is an image of his unflinching obstruction in his involved land. It implies a ton for him. It is a critical piece of his opposition. The warriors had seen the Palestinian banner made of stones spread out at the entry at Container's ground. Two of them were kicking at it with their boots; separating it ... Karim secured his clench hands, feeling significantly more defenseless and embarrassed. 'Get out! Get out!' he murmured. 'This is our place. Leave'(163).

Conclusion:

These novels intricately weave the personal with the political. While the characters face the universal struggles of adolescence—identity crises, familial tensions, and dreams of the future—their experiences are indelibly marked by the socio-political upheavals surrounding them. The streets they play in, the schools they attend, and even the simple act of looking out of a window are laden with layers of political significance.

One of the most compelling aspects of this work is refusal to present a monolithic view of resistance. As portrayed in the novels, resistance takes multiple forms—from the overt acts of protesting and stone-throwing to the more subtle forms of remembering, singing, and even dreaming. Such a nuanced depiction challenges the reader to reconsider preconceived notions about what resistance looks like and to appreciate the myriad ways in which the human spirit can rebel against subjugation.

In wrapping up our exploration of "*A Little Piece of Ground*" and "*A Stone in My Hand*," it becomes evident that literature, especially when delving into themes of violence and resistance, has the profound ability to mirror society, highlight its flaws, and simultaneously offer a vision of hope. Laird's and Clinton's works are not just stories; they are clarion calls for peace, understanding, and the universal recognition of our shared humanity.

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الملخص العربي

يهدف هذا البحث بعنوان " العنف والمقاومة في رواية قطعة صغيرة من الأرض " للكاتبة اليزابيث ليرد الى تحليل أنواع المقاومة في إطار أنواع المقاومة الثلاثة للكاتب مارتن لوثر كينج وكيف تعامل الأطفال مع العنف الاسرائيلي وتصنيف كل طفل لنوع من أنواع المقاومة وهم العنف – الوسطية – الانتقام .